

Barosaurus

BAH-roe-SORE-us



- **When** 155–145 million years ago (Late Jurassic)
- **Fossil location** USA
- **Habitat** Plains of N. America
- **Length** 92 ft (28 m)
- **Diet** Plants

The first *Barosaurus* remains were found during the “Bone Wars” of the late 1800s, when a number of fossil hunters raced to out-do each other with new dinosaur fossil discoveries. In 1922, three *Barosaurus* skeletons were found at Carnegie Quarry in Utah, suggesting that *Barosaurus* may have roamed in herds.



Feeding on stones

Barosaurus’s large peglike teeth were perfect for pulling leaves off trees, but not for chewing them. Some scientists thought it swallowed stones to help grind food in its stomach, but recent research has shown that it used bacteria in its gut to digest food.



Sticking its neck out?

In 1993, a model *Barosaurus* was mounted rearing on its hind legs. Some scientists think this position is incorrect—the heart could not have been strong enough to pump blood vertically upward to the brain. New research suggests that with the right-sized heart, this is indeed possible.

Spiny back

No one is sure why *Barosaurus* had spines running along its back—they may have been used for defense, or may simply have been a decorative feature. These spines were bony plates fixed in the skin and were not attached to the skeleton. *Barosaurus*’s rough, scaly skin gave it much needed protection against scratches and bite wounds. It also helped reduce moisture loss from its body when the climate turned dry.

